

Joomla Tutorial (Step-by-Step)

Joomla is an open-source content management system (CMS) for publishing web content. Like many other CMS, Joomla lets you build a website without using HTML or CSS. That and its zero price tag makes it a favorite option among many businesses and non-profit organizations.

In this step-by-step Joomla tutorial, we will learn how to use the platform to create whatever website you need. We will cover how to install Joomla on your server and give you an overview of its functionality.

In the end, we want you to feel comfortable to start exploring Joomla by yourself and keep building on your knowledge.

How to build a Joomla website (table of contents):

- 1 [Get](#) a domain name and web hosting service
- 2 [Install and set up](#) Joomla
- 3 [Get familiar](#) with Joomla basics
- 4 [Select a template](#) for your site
- 5 [Install](#) your Joomla template
- 6 [Customize](#) the design
- 7 [Create content](#) using Joomla modules
- 8 [Assign](#) modules to positions
- 9 [Create](#) new pages
- 10 [Assign pages](#) to the Joomla navigation menu
- 11 [Add](#) a blog section
- 12 [Install extensions](#)

Total time to create a website using Joomla: ~2-3 hours

Skill level: Beginner/Intermediate

Ready? Let's start.

1. Get a Web Hosting Plan and Choose a Domain Name

Hint: If you already have a domain name and web hosting, skip to [step 2](#).

Before you can start building your Joomla site, you'll need a domain name and web hosting. If you don't even know where to start on this topic, read our post on [how to choose a domain name](#) and our [comparison of web hosting services](#).

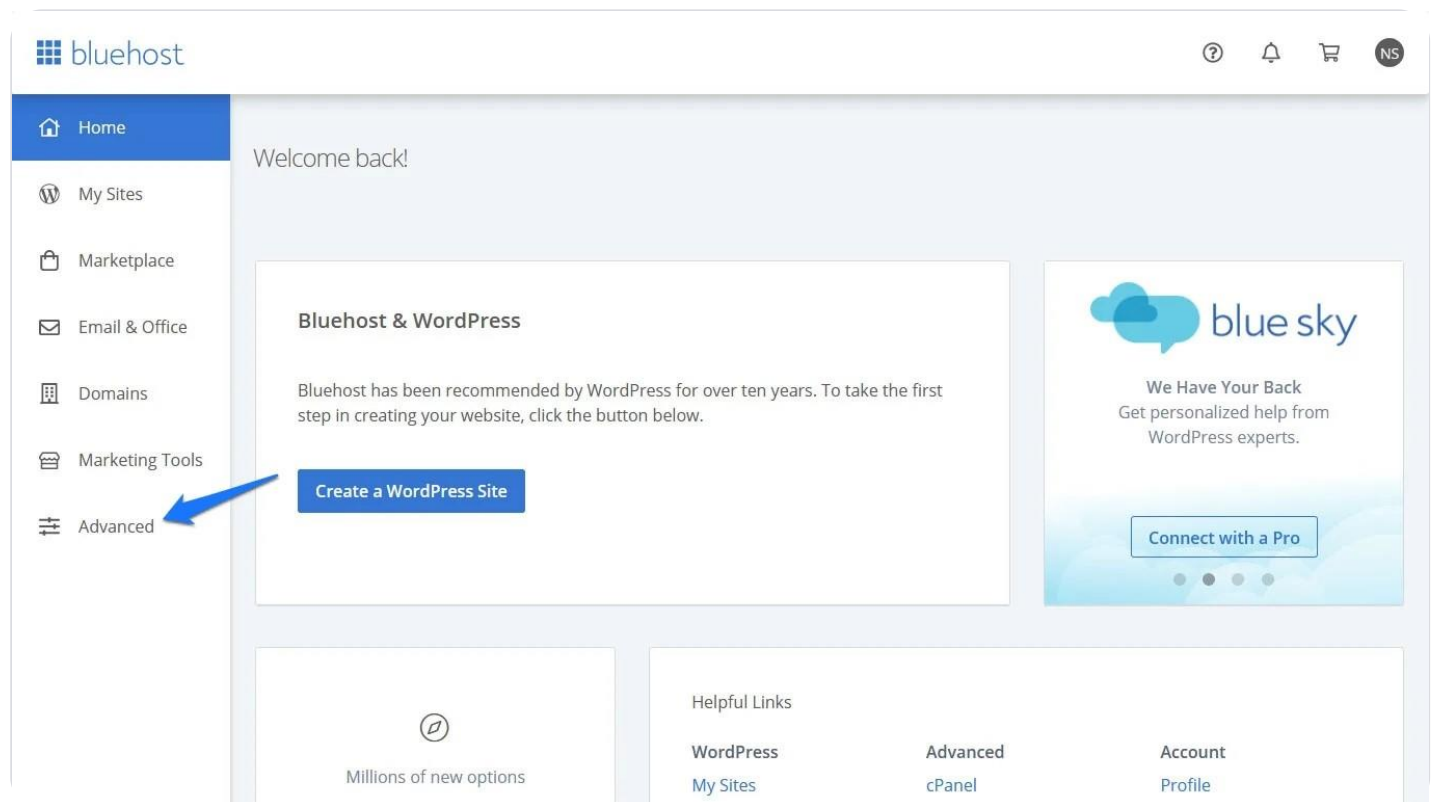
We recommend choosing something cheap to get started with your project. Yet, whichever web host you pick, make sure it meets [Joomla's system requirements](#).

2. Install and Set Up Joomla

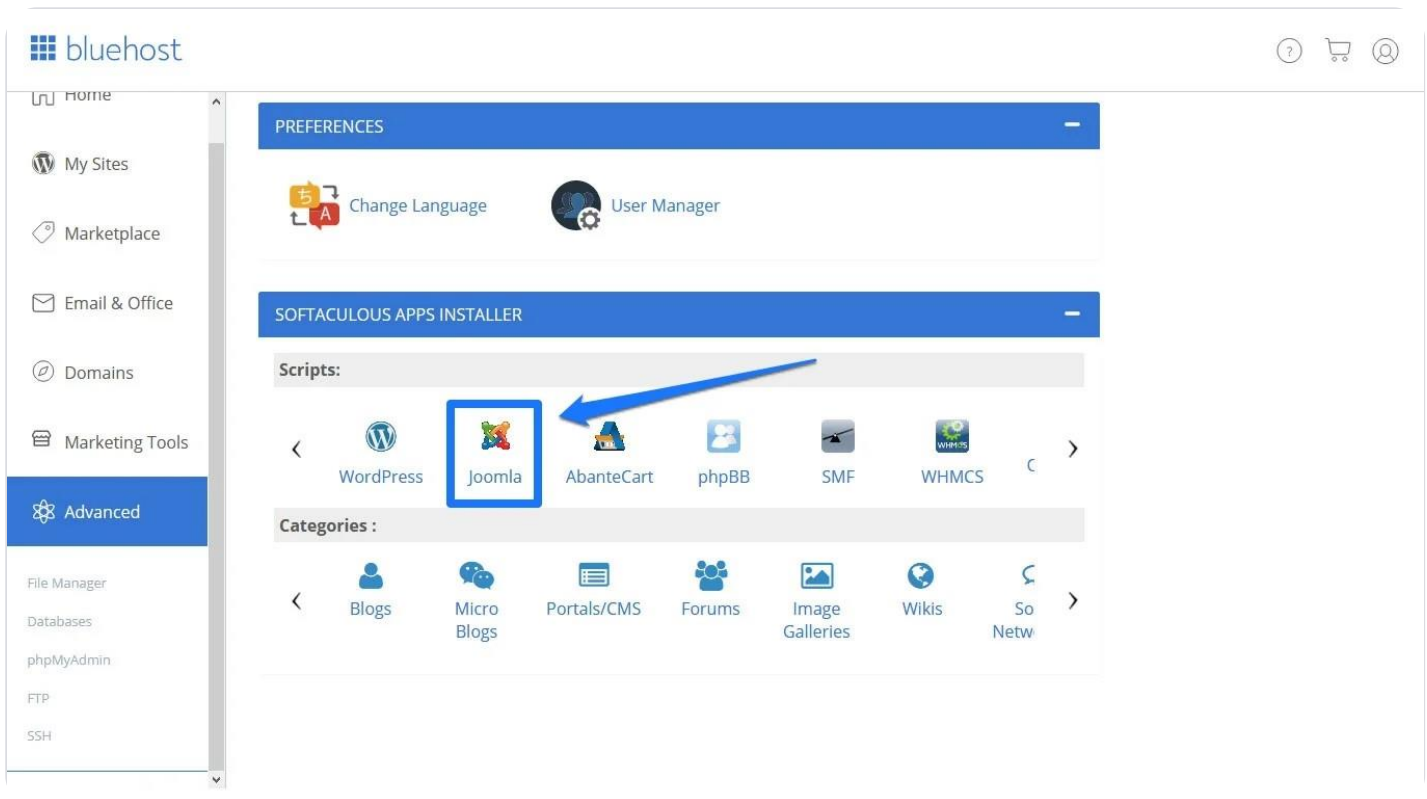
The first step of the tutorial: how to install and set up Joomla. There are two ways:

2a. Using Bluehost and Quick Install

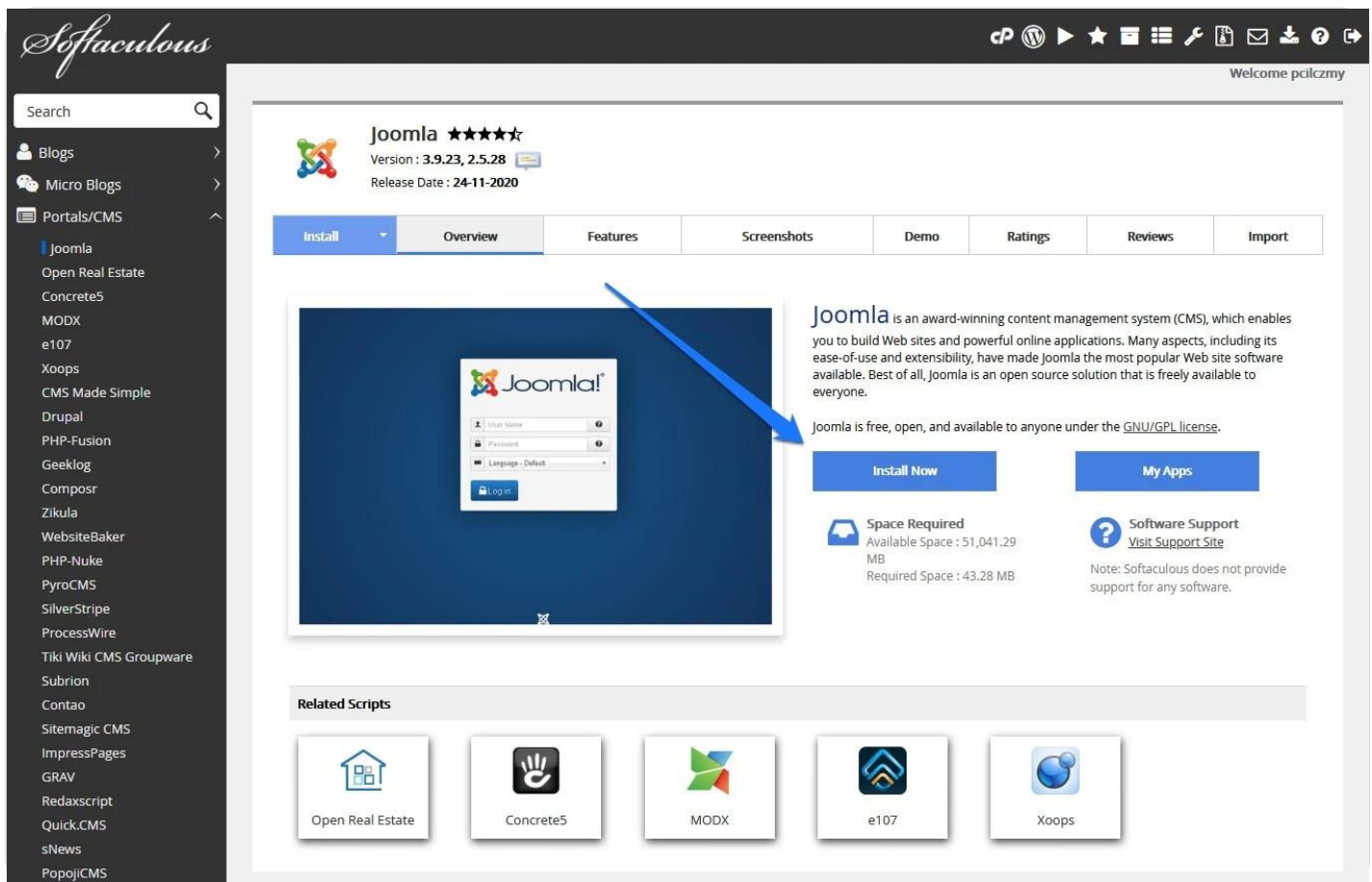
Once you've signed up and grabbed a domain at [Bluehost](#), log into your account and click on Advanced in the left column.



Scroll down to the bottom, look for the Joomla icon and click on it.



In the next screen, press Install Now.



This will take you to the installation screen.



Joomla ★★★★★
Version : 3.9.24, 2.5.28
Release Date : 12-01-2021

Install

Overview

Features

Screenshots

Demo

Ratings

Reviews

Import

Software Setup

Quick Install

Choose the version you want to install

Please select the version to install.

3.9.24

Choose Installation URL

Please choose the URL to install the software

https://

pci.lcz.mybluehost.me

In Directory

Choose Protocol

Choose Domain

In Directory

Site Settings

Site Name

My Joomla

Site Description

My Joomla CMS

Database Settings

Import Sample Data

None

Admin Account

Admin Username

admin

Admin Password

pass

Bad (18/100)

Hide

Real Name

Administrator

Admin Email

admin@pci.lcz.mybluehost.me

Choose Language

Select Language

English

Advanced Options

Install

Email installation details to:

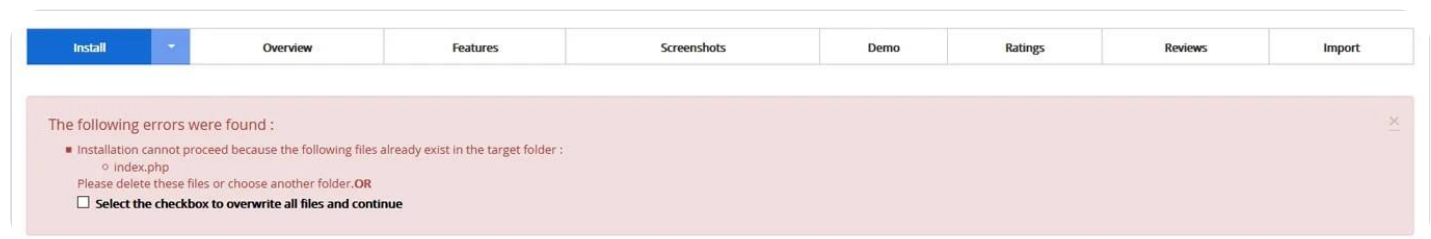
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Here's how to ll it in:

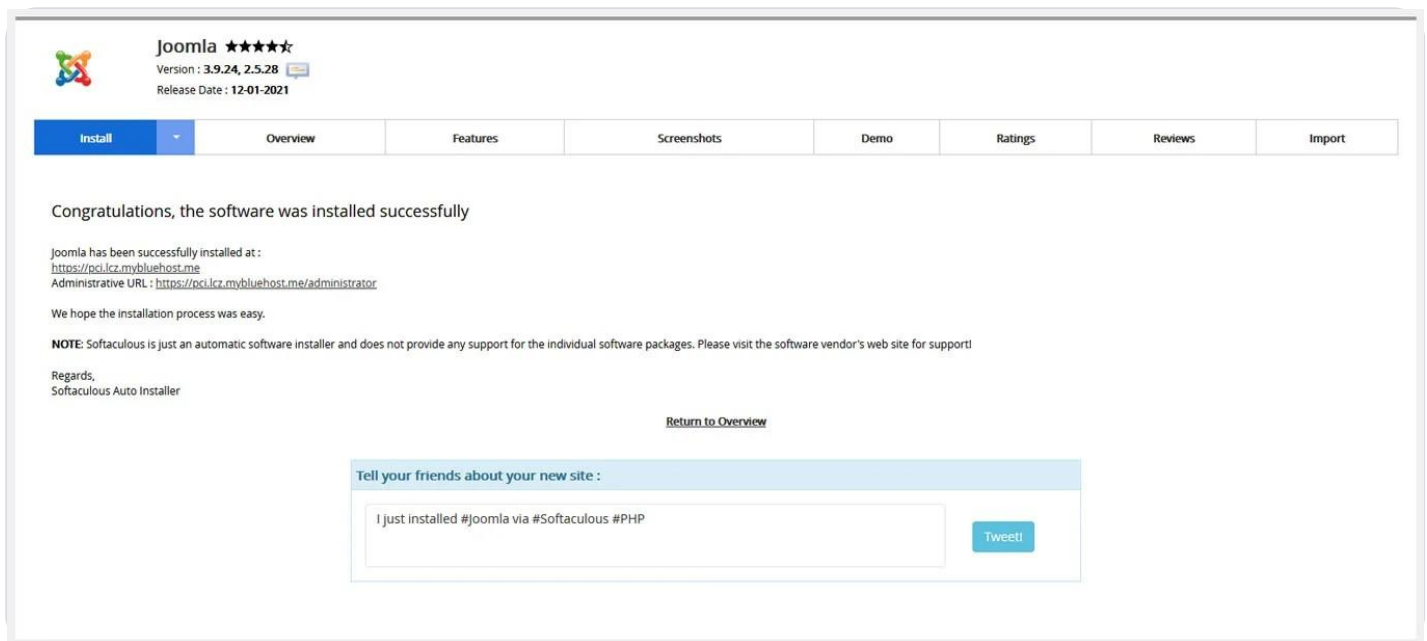
- Software Setup — You'll notice that your Bluehost domain has been included by default. Unless you have a good reason to change it, just leave everything as is.

- **Site Settings** — This is the site name and description that will appear in search engines. Therefore, it's a good idea to change the default. However, you can also do it later inside Joomla itself so don't stress out about it too much.
- **Database Settings** — This is an option to include sample data on your site. Since, in this tutorial, we want to learn Joomla from scratch, we will leave it at None.
- **Admin Account** — Make sure to choose a secure username and password for your administration account and enter your real name and email address.
- **Choose Language** — If you want your Joomla installation in any other language than English, you can change it here.
- **Advanced Options** — In this place, you can modify your database name, table prefix, disable email notifications for available updates, and control whether Joomla should automatically update or not. These settings are all optional and you can usually leave them as they are.

Once you are done, click Install at the bottom. When you do, you might run into the warning below.



However, don't worry about it. It's just the default `index.php` page. Just check the box and click Install again. After that, the installation will run, until you are met with this success screen:



Congratulations! You've just installed Joomla on your Bluehost domain.

2b. Manual Installation (Any Web Hosting)

If you are with a hosting provider that does not have the option above, you will have to install Joomla manually. Don't worry, it's very easy.

1. Create a Database and Upload Files

The first step is to create a MySQL database. This is where Joomla stores all of your content and it is a vital part of any website built with the CMS. You should find options to create one in your host's control panel.

-  Home
-  My Sites
-  Marketplace
-  Email & Office
-  Domains
-  Marketing Tools

Advanced

File Manager

Databases

phpMyAdmin

FTP

SSH

MySQL® Databases

Manage large amounts of information over the web easily. MySQL databases are necessary to run many web-based applications, such as bulletin boards, content management systems, and online shopping carts. For more information, read the [documentation](#).

[↓ Jump to MySQL Users](#)

Create New Database

New Database:

pcilczmy_

[Create Database](#)

Modify Databases

Check Database[Check Database](#)**Repair Database**[Repair Database](#)

Current Databases

Search

[Go](#)

Database	Size	Privileged Users	Actions
----------	------	------------------	---------

There are no databases associated with your account.

Page Size 10 << < > >>

[↑ Jump to MySQL Databases](#)

MySQL Users

Add New User

Username

pcilczmy_

Password**Password (Again)****Strength** ⓘ

Very Weak (0/100)

[Password Generator](#)[Create User](#)

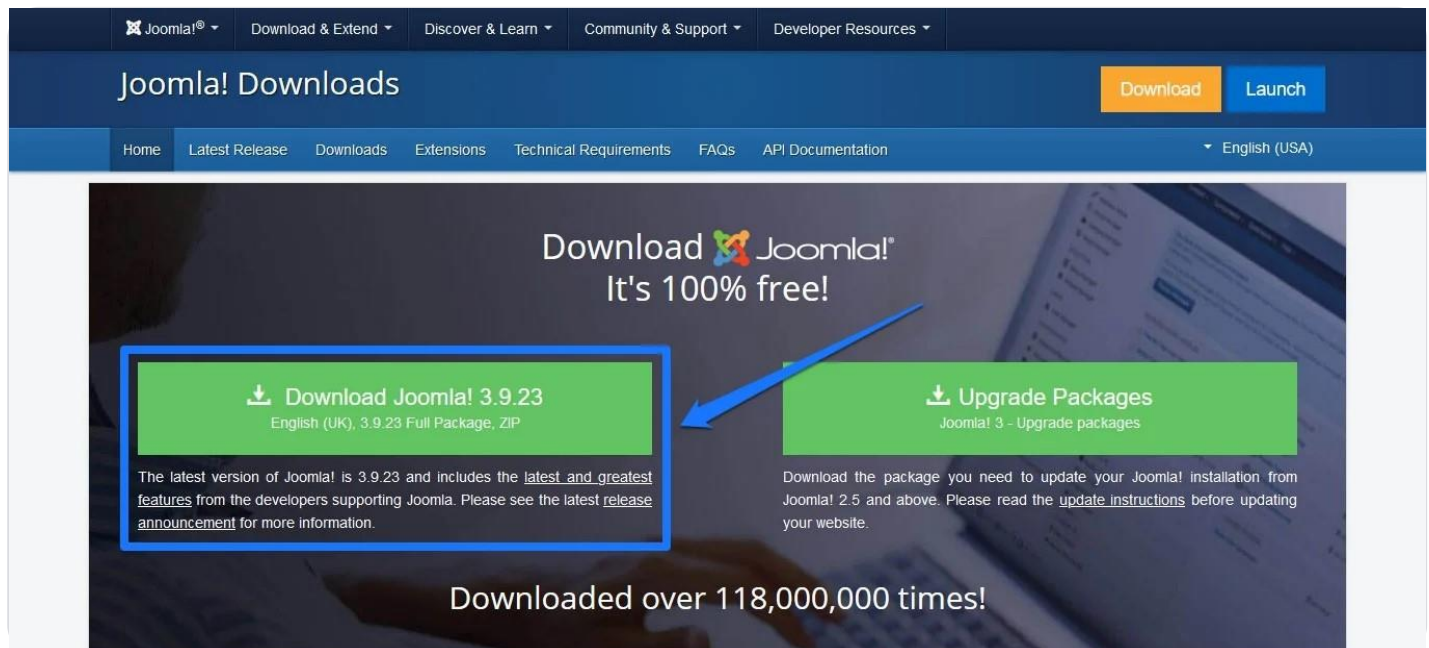
Current Users

Users	Actions
pcilczmy_WPR25	Change Password Rename Delete

To install Joomla, you need the following information:

- The name of an (empty) database
- Name of a user associated with that database
- The password of that user
- Your database server address

Once you have that, it's time to upload Joomla to your server. For that, head on over to the [download section of the Joomla homepage](#) and hit the big green download button (at the time of this writing, Joomla 3 is the latest major version, with [Joomla 4 in beta status](#)).



Make sure to save the zip file to your hard drive and, when it's finished, extract all files. After that, connect to your server via FTP (e.g. through [FileZilla](#)) and upload the extracted files to where your domain is pointing (usually the root directory).

Once that is finished, it's time to move on to the next step.

2. Run the Manual Installation

When all files are on your server, open a browser window and input your site URL.

If you have done everything right, this should start the Joomla installation process.



Joomla! is free software released under the GNU General Public License.

1 Configuration 2 Database 3 Overview

Select Language English (United States) [Next](#)

Main Configuration

Site Name *		Super User Account Details	
	Enter the name of your Joomla! site.	Email *	
			Enter an email address. This will be the email address of the website Super User.
Description		Username *	
	Enter a description of the overall website that is to be used by search engines. Generally, a maximum of 20 words is best.		Set the username for your Super User account.
		Password *	
			Set the password for your Super User account and confirm it in the field below.
		Confirm Password *	
Site Offline	☐ Yes ☒ No		
	Set the site Frontend offline when installation is completed. The site can be set online later on through the Global Configuration.		
			Next

<

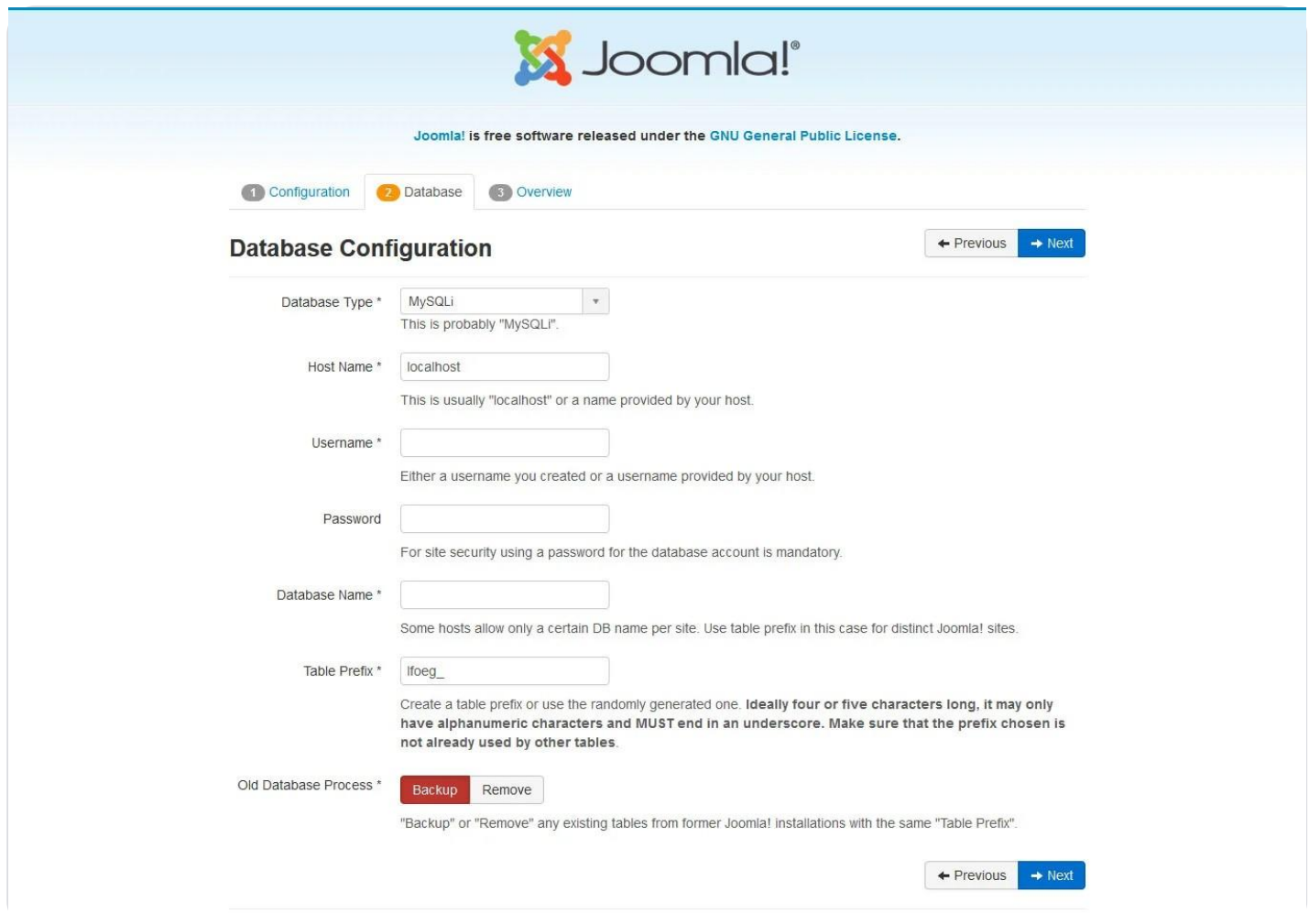
At the top, make sure to pick the right language for your site. Below that, enter your site's name and, optionally, a description. As mentioned, this is the stuff that will show up in search engines but you can also change it all later if you are not happy with your first choices.

On the right, you will be asked to enter the information for your Super User account. That is the main administrator, so be sure to enter a valid email address, a user name that isn't easy to guess, and a safe password (twice).

Finally, at the bottom, you can select to set your site's front end to offline mode after installation. That way, only logged-in users will see it. This can make sense for development projects and is up to you. When you are done, hit Next.

3. Connect Joomla to Your MySQL Database The next

screen is this:



The screenshot shows the Joomla! installation interface. At the top is the Joomla! logo and a notice: "Joomla! is free software released under the GNU General Public License." Below this are three tabs: "1 Configuration", "2 Database" (which is active), and "3 Overview". The main heading is "Database Configuration". To the right of the heading are "Previous" and "Next" buttons. The form contains several fields with labels and asterisks indicating they are required:

- Database Type ***: A dropdown menu with "MySQLi" selected. Below it is a hint: "This is probably 'MySQLi'".
- Host Name ***: A text input field containing "localhost". Below it is a hint: "This is usually 'localhost' or a name provided by your host."
- Username ***: An empty text input field. Below it is a hint: "Either a username you created or a username provided by your host."
- Password**: An empty text input field. Below it is a hint: "For site security using a password for the database account is mandatory."
- Database Name ***: An empty text input field. Below it is a hint: "Some hosts allow only a certain DB name per site. Use table prefix in this case for distinct Joomla! sites."
- Table Prefix ***: A text input field containing "lfoeg_". Below it is a hint: "Create a table prefix or use the randomly generated one. Ideally four or five characters long, it may only have alphanumeric characters and MUST end in an underscore. Make sure that the prefix chosen is not already used by other tables."
- Old Database Process ***: A section with two buttons, "Backup" (in red) and "Remove", and a hint below: "'Backup' or 'Remove' any existing tables from former Joomla! installations with the same 'Table Prefix'."

At the bottom right of the form are "Previous" and "Next" buttons.

Here, you will need the database information from earlier. Fill everything in like so:

- **Database Type** — In most cases, you can simply leave this as is.
- **Host Name** — This is the hosting location of your database. Change it if it's anything else than localhost.

Username — The username associated with your database.

- **Password** — In this field goes the password for your MySQL database.
- **Database Name** — Here, include the name of the database you want to connect your Joomla website.

- Table Prefix — Unless you have good reason to change this, use the randomly generated prefix offered by the installation.
- Old Database Process — If there is already any data in your database, you can choose whether Joomla should delete or save it.

Again, once you are ready, hit the Next button.

4. Finish the Installation

The final screen of the Joomla installation is mostly a summary of everything you have done so far following the tutorial.



Joomla! is free software released under the GNU General Public License.

1 Configuration 2 Database 3 Overview

Finalization

← Previous → Install

Install Sample Data ☒ None (Required for basic native multilingual site creation)

- ☐ Blog English (GB) Sample Data
- ☐ Brochure English (GB) Sample Data
- ☐ Default English (GB) Sample Data
- ☐ Learn Joomla English (GB) Sample Data

Installing sample data is strongly recommended for beginners.
This will install sample content that is included in the Joomla! installation package.

Overview

Email Configuration Yes No

Send configuration settings to email@domain.com by email after installation.

Main Configuration

Site Name	Joomla Local Test Site
Site Offline	No
Email	email@domain.com
Username	user

Database Configuration

Database Type	mysql
Host Name	localhost
Username	user
Database Name	joomla2
Table Prefix	lfoeg_
Old Database Process	Backup

Pre-Installation Check

If any of these items are not supported (marked as No) then please take actions to correct them.
You can't install Joomla! until your setup meets the requirements below.

PHP Version >= 5.3.10	Yes
Magic Quotes GPC Off	Yes
Register Globals Off	Yes
Zlib Compression Support	Yes
XML Support	Yes
Database Support: (mysql, pdo, pdo_mysql, sqlite)	Yes
MB Language is Default	Yes
MB String Overload Off	Yes
INI Parser Support	Yes
JSON Support	Yes
configuration.php Writeable	Yes

Recommended settings:

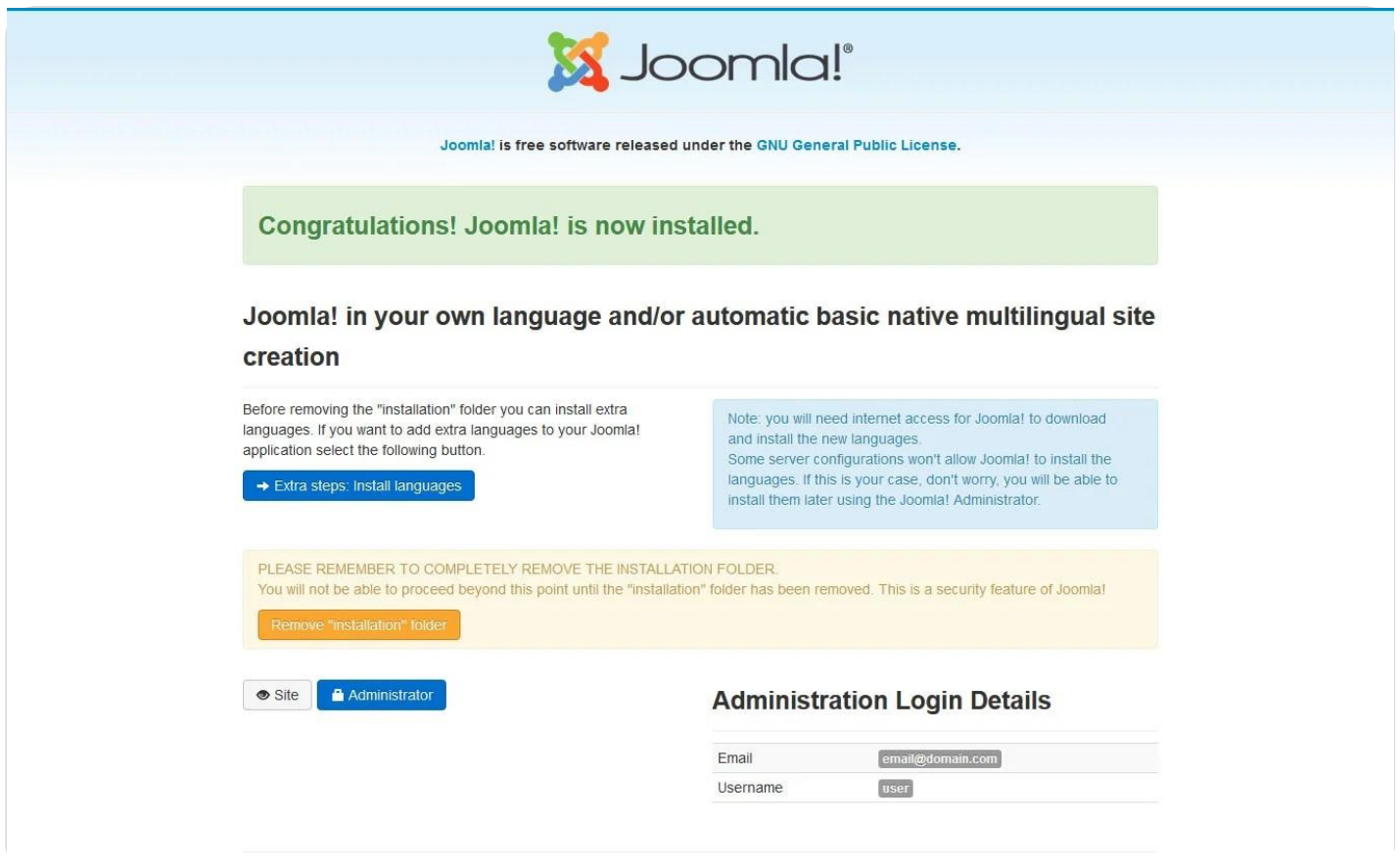
These settings are recommended for PHP to ensure full compatibility with Joomla.
However, Joomla! will still operate if your settings do not quite match the recommended configuration.

Directive	Recommended	Actual
Safe Mode	Off	Off
Display Errors	Off	On
File Uploads	On	On
Magic Quotes Runtime	Off	Off
Output Buffering	Off	On
Session Auto Start	Off	Off
Native ZIP support	On	On

← Previous → Install

At the top, you can choose whether to install any sample data. For the purpose of this Joomla tutorial, leave it at None. Under Overview, determine whether the installation should send the con guration to your Super User's email address.

Aside from that, you only need to check if everything is as you like and if your server environment passes the requirements of Joomla. When all of that is the case, you can click Install. Joomla will then set up the CMS on your server. Once nished, you will see this screen:

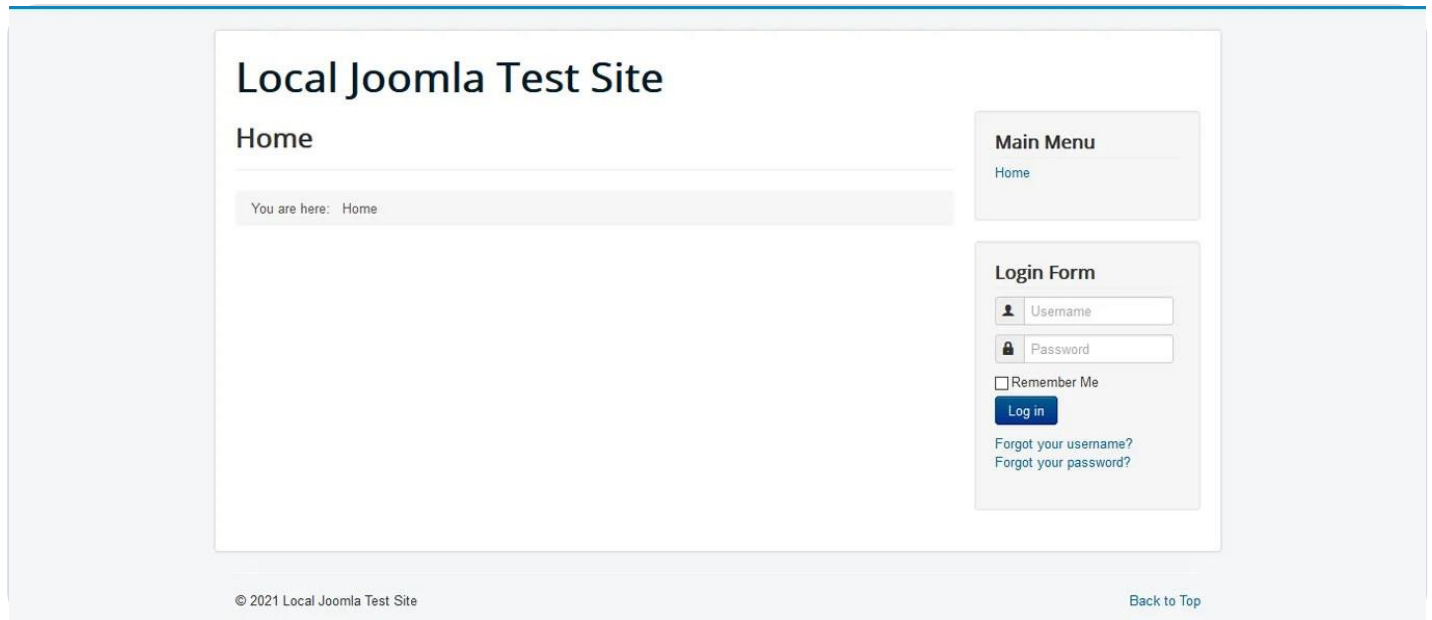


(Ideally) it tells you that Joomla has been successfully installed. You also have the option to add more languages. If you don't want to do that, don't forget to remove the installation folder by clicking the yellow button. This will get rid of sensitive files on your server.

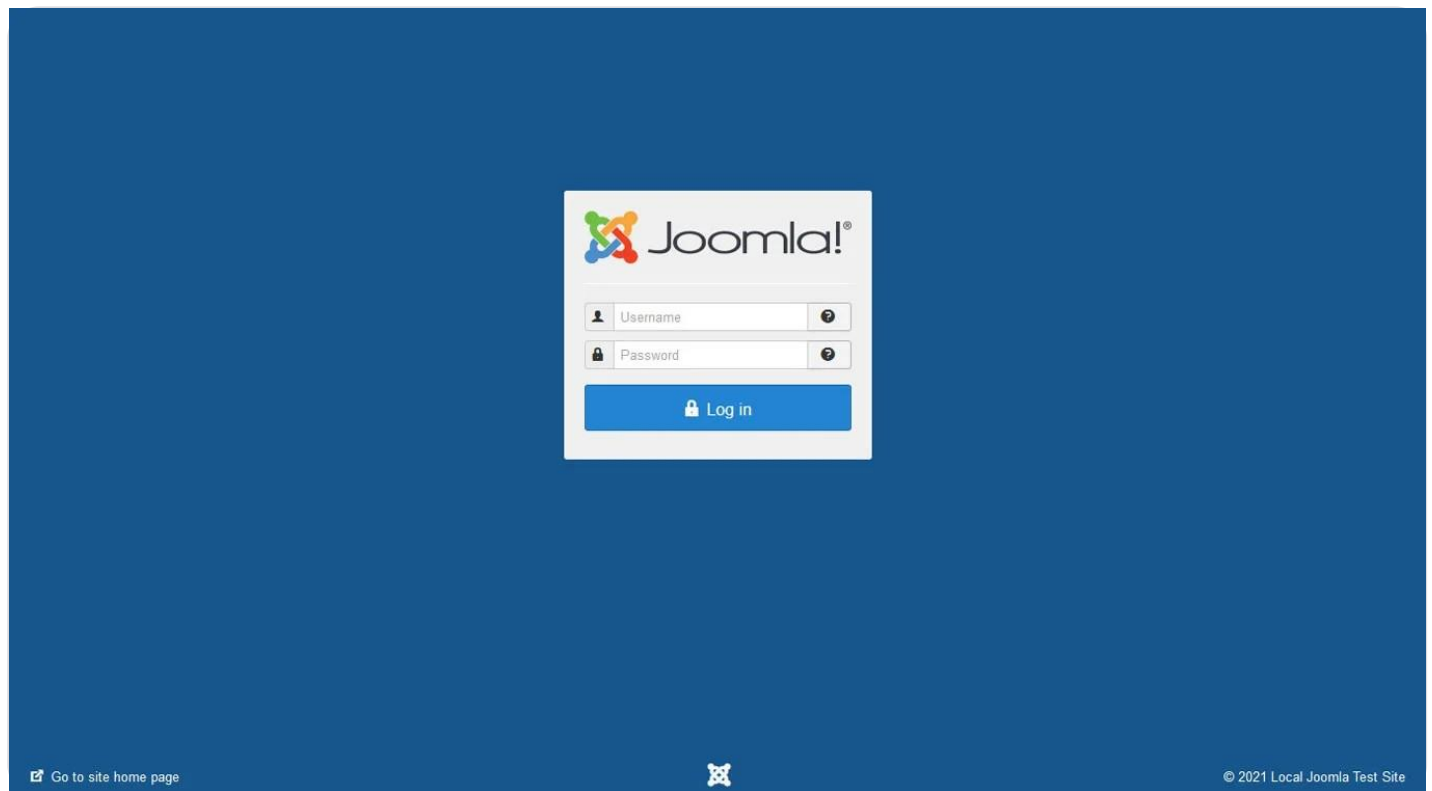
That's it! Cool beans, you just installed Joomla completely by hand.

3. Get Familiar with Joomla Basics

At this point, when you go to the address where your new Joomla website lies, the front end looks like this:↑



Not super impressive, right? To make any changes, we first have to log into the Joomla back end. For that, go to yourdomain.com/administrator.



In the screen that follows, enter your chosen username and password to land on the Joomla control panel.



The screenshot shows the Joomla! Control Panel dashboard. At the top is a dark blue header with a navigation menu (System, Users, Menus, Content, Components, Extensions, Help) and a user profile icon. Below the header is a light blue banner with a message from Joomla! asking for permission to collect statistics, with buttons for 'Always', 'Once', and 'Never'. The main content area is divided into two columns. The left column contains a sidebar with categories: CONTENT (New Article, Articles, Categories, Media), STRUCTURE (Menu(s), Modules), USERS (Users, No Urgent Requests), CONFIGURATION (Global, Templates, Language(s)), EXTENSIONS (Install Extensions), and MAINTENANCE (Joomla is up to date, All extensions are up to date). The right column displays several informational boxes: 'You have post-installation messages' with a 'Read Messages' button; 'SAMPLE DATA' with a 'Blog Sample data' link; 'LATEST ACTIONS' showing a user login; 'PRIVACY DASHBOARD' with a 'There are no requests' message; 'LOGGED-IN USERS' showing the 'Super User Administration'; 'POPULAR ARTICLES' with 'No Matching Results'; and 'RECENTLY ADDED ARTICLES' with 'No Matching Results'.

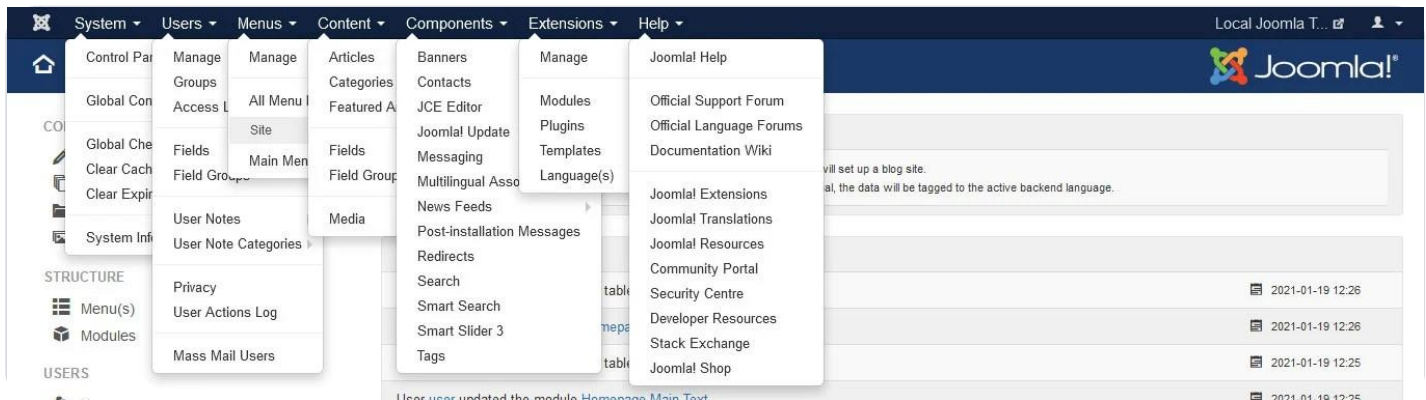
We will use many of the menus you can see here throughout this Joomla tutorial, however, let's start with a quick overview.

Obviously, you can get rid of the two blue boxes by opting in or out of Joomla collecting statistical data, and then reading (and hiding) your post-installation messages.

On the left, you find shortcuts to frequently used parts of the admin area, such as creating new articles, changing the menu structure, or installing extensions. On the right is important information about the state of your site.

The Heart of Joomla: The Taskbar

However, the most important part is the taskbar at the top.



Here, you find the same options as in the control panel and then some. This is what the different menus contain:

- **System** — Access to the control panel, site settings, pending or locked content items, the option to clear cache, and view system information (site, server, and environment).
- **Users** — Manage users, user groups, and access levels, add notes about users, deal with privacy related requests, view user logs, and mass email everyone on your site.
- **Menus** — As the name suggests, this contains all options about the creation and management of menus.
- **Content** — Add articles and taxonomies, assign featured content, and manage your site's media files.
- **Components** — Create and manage site banners, contacts, site updates, private messages, multilingual associations, and news feeds. It also provides access to postinstallation messages (we already covered those), lets you set up redirects (though you need a plugin for that), view site search terms, use the smart search (again, this needs a plugin), and manage tags.
- **Extensions** — Allows you to install, update, manage, configure, and troubleshoot extensions. In this menu, you can also see the state of your database and update your site.

↑ **Help** — Direct access to important help topics in the [official documentation](#).

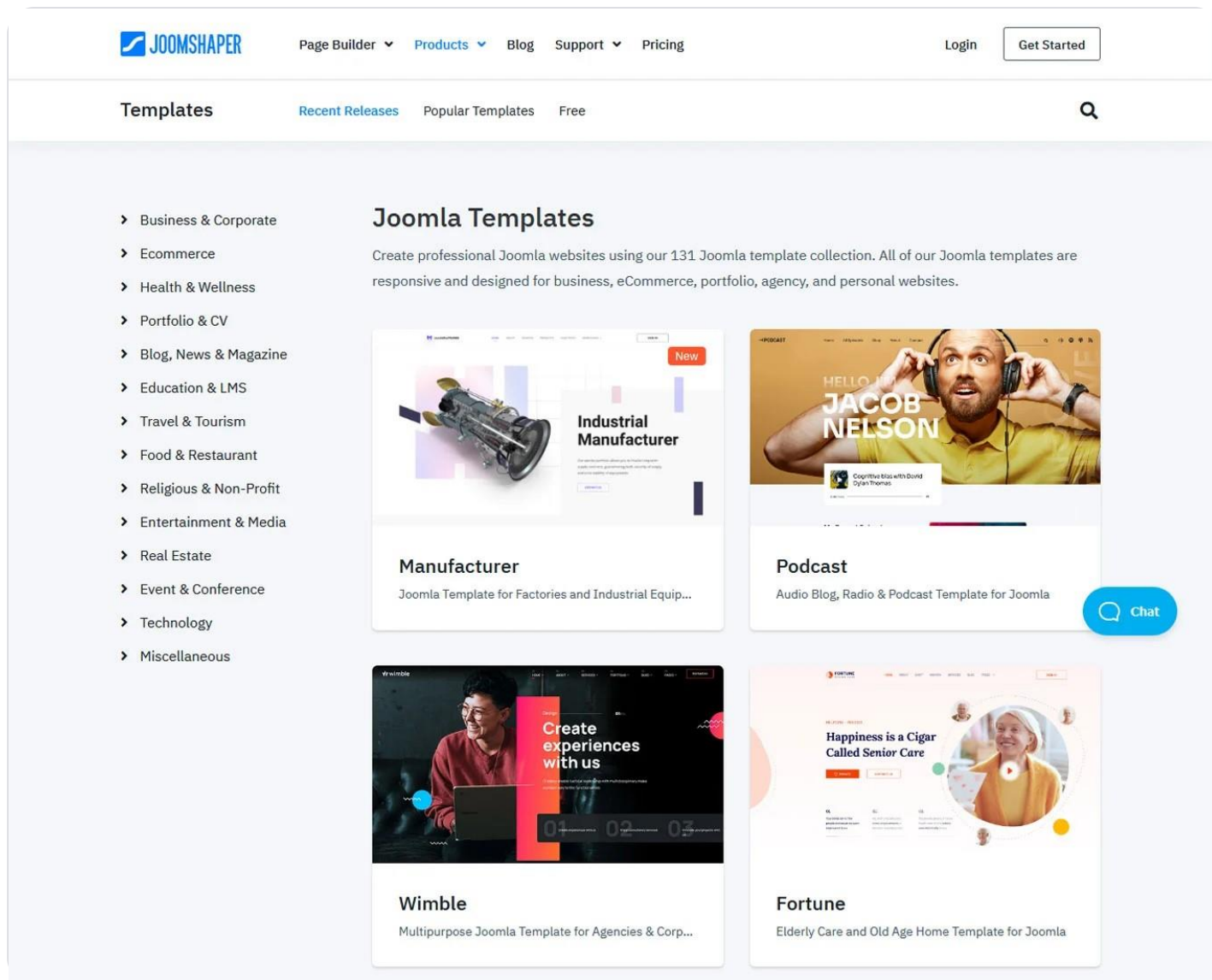
All clear so far? Then let's move on.

4. Select a Template for Your Site

Like other CMS, Joomla offers a way to change your site design without coding, which is what we will look at in this step of the tutorial. In Joomla, your entire website's look, feel, and functionality are entirely dependent on so-called templates.

There are free and premium (paid) Joomla templates available. However, finding one can be tricky. Unfortunately, the CMS does not have a central directory for this. Therefore, you need to look to shops to find them. Many of those who sell premium themes also offer free versions you can test drive. Here are a few places to get started:

- [TemplateMonster](#)
- [Joomlart](#)
- [Joomdev](#)
- [JoomShaper](#)



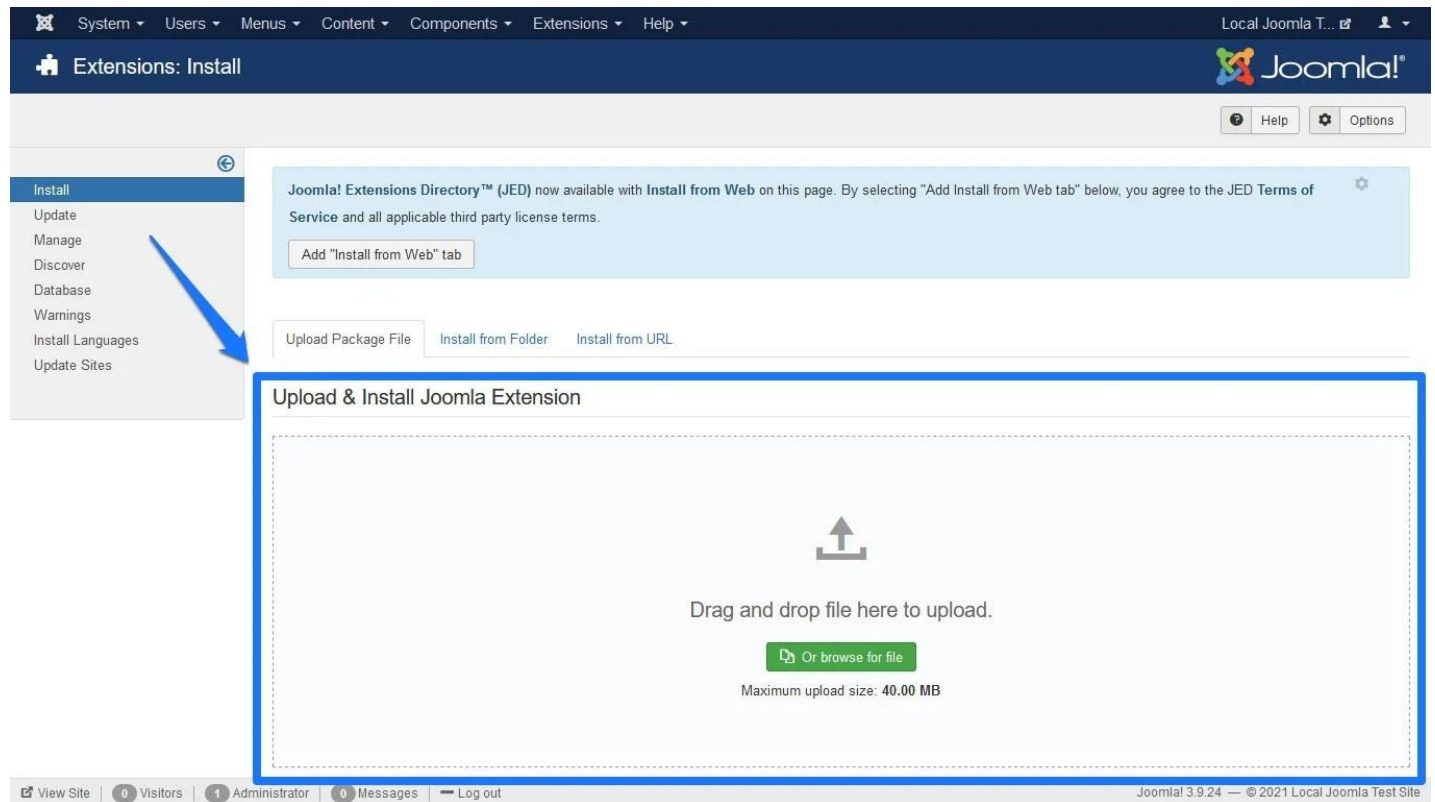
When selecting a template, besides your own taste, pay attention to a few important characteristics:

- **Support** — It's great to have technical support included, to have someone to help you with issues.
- **Updates** — Joomla constantly updates their system. Make sure your template provider does the same with their products so they will work with the latest release.
- **Documentation** — From time to time, you'll need to check some features to learn how they work. Be sure there is a place where you can do so.
- **Customizability** — Check out which template features can be customized by yourself. For example, look for templates that have many module positions (more on that soon).



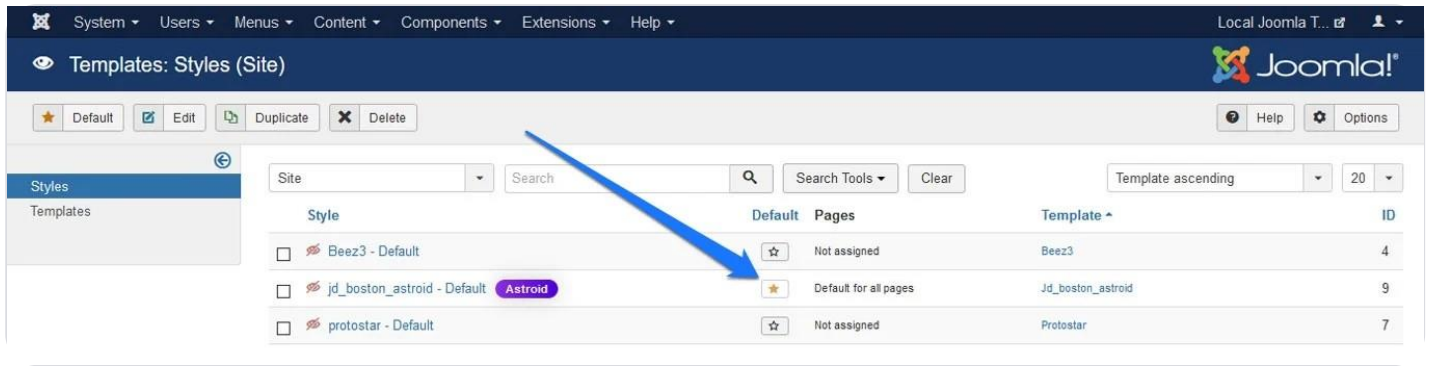
5. Install Your Joomla Template

Installing a template in Joomla is quite easy in principle. Once you have made a choice, you usually get it in the form of a zip file. This you can simply upload under Extensions > Manage > Install.

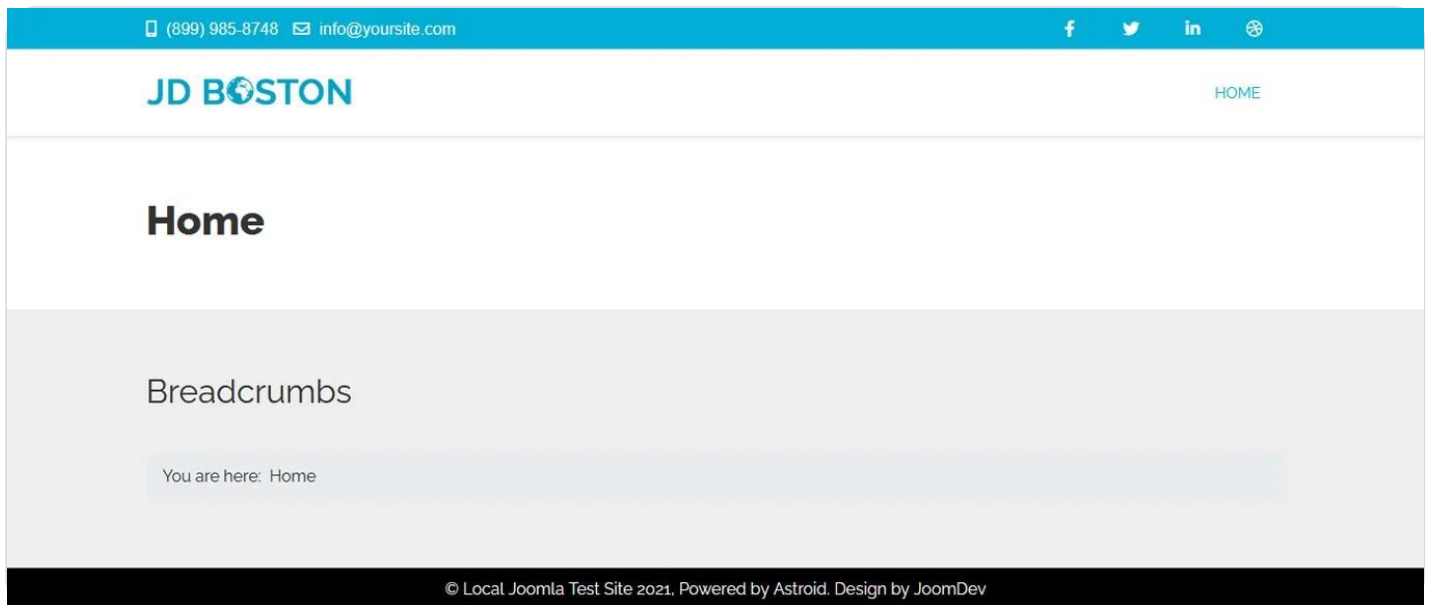


Either drag and drop the file into the field or click the Or browse for file button to find it on your hard drive. Select it and Joomla should do the rest by itself. Alternatively, you can also install the template via its URL if you know where the package is located.

After that, you still need to activate the template under Extensions > Template > Styles. Here, click the star icon to the right of the template name to make it the default for the entire site.



When you now go back to the front end of your site, you will see that its entire design has changed. Such is the power of templates.



Note that, when downloading your template, you might get additional files such as quickstart, settings, and extension.

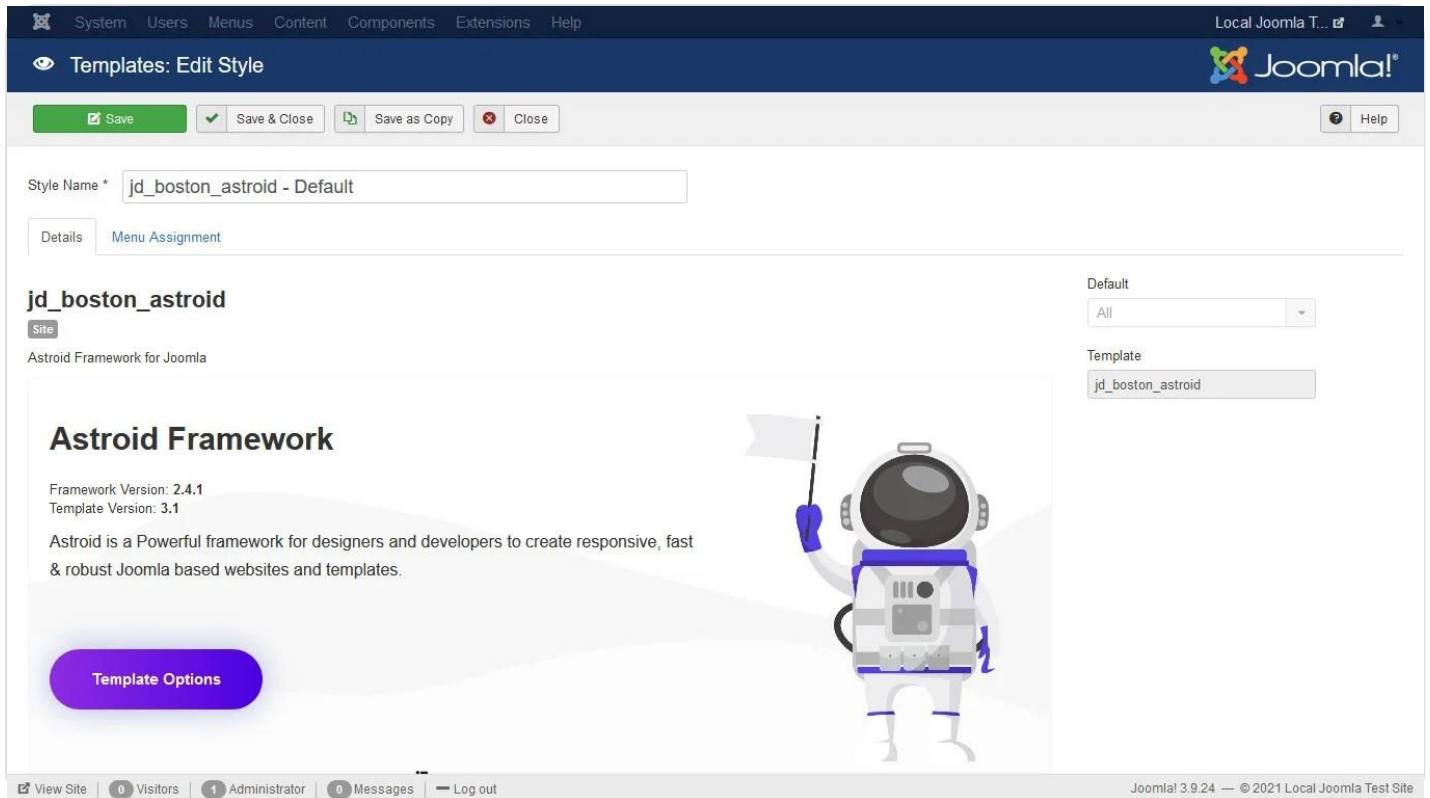
The first is a complete version of Joomla including the template. When you install that, your new design is ready to go when your site is set up, often including demo content. It's a shortcut when you want the exact design as the template advertises.

All that's left to do is exchange the content.

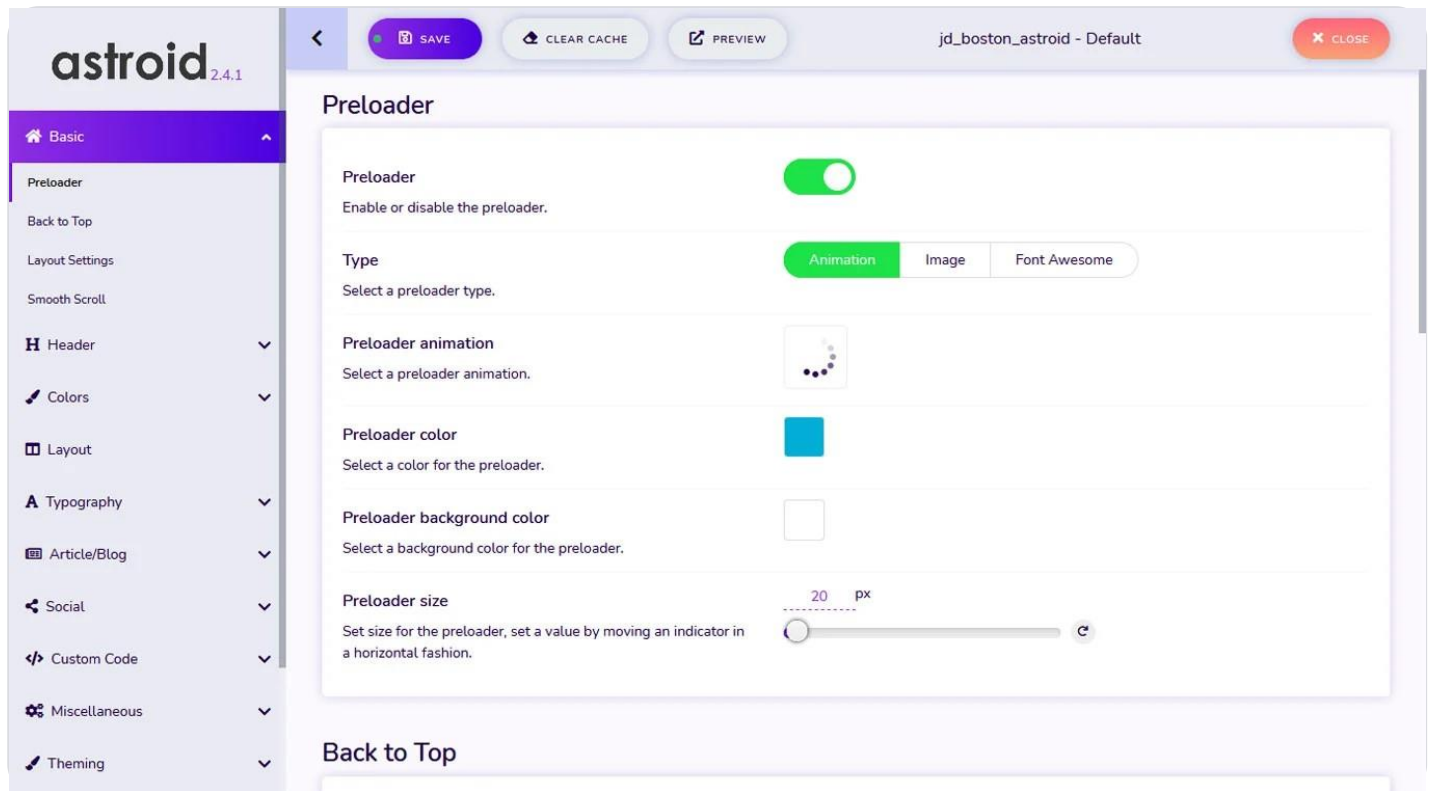
The other two files refer to stuff that you might have seen in the template demo site, such as sliders, etc.

6. Customize the Design

Most templates come with at least some customization options. You can access them by clicking on the template name in the list.



In the settings, you can make adjustments to things like [colors](#), fonts, [logos](#), sizes, and much more. In this case, the template even comes with its own settings page that we get to when we hit Template Options.



Some Joomla templates also have a preview option where you can see changes in real-time. In either case, don't forget to check out what your template has to offer and to save any changes you have made to translate them to your site. For example, below we have changed the social pro les and contact information in the top bar disabled the branding at the bottom and moved the top bar to the bottom of the page via the Layout options.



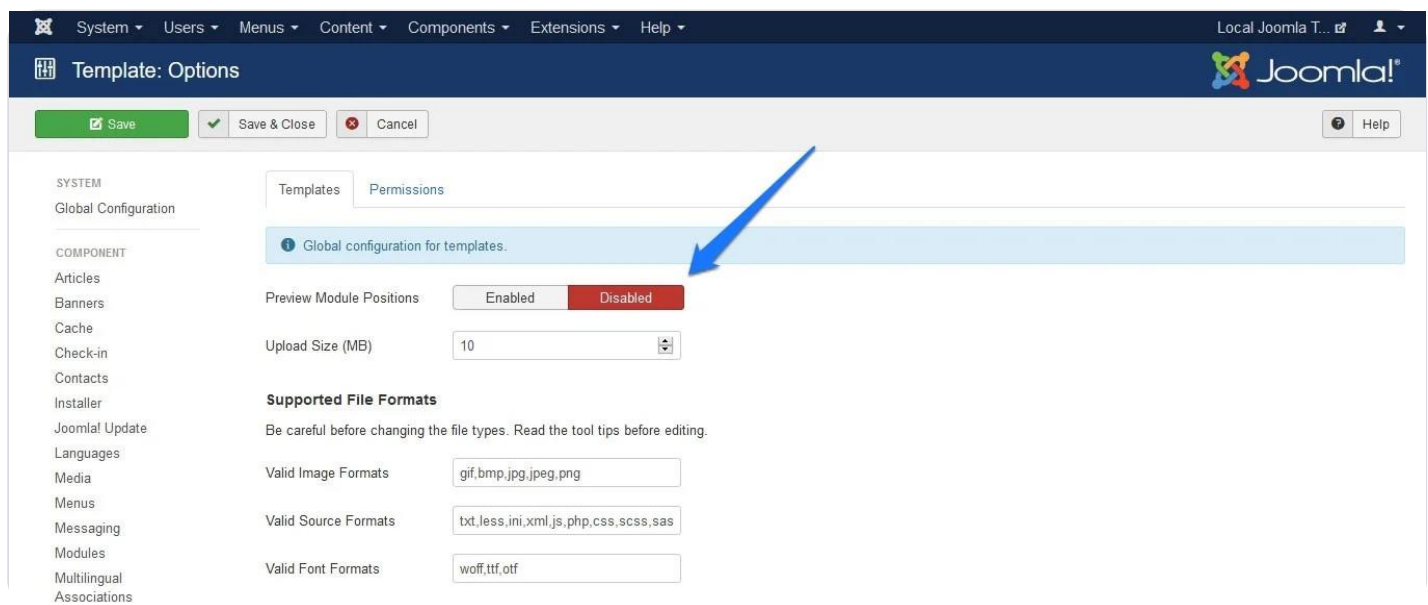
7. Create Content Using Joomla Modules

Right now, even if it looks better, your site is still pretty empty. Time to change that.

At this point in our tutorial, we will go over how to use Joomla to create content.

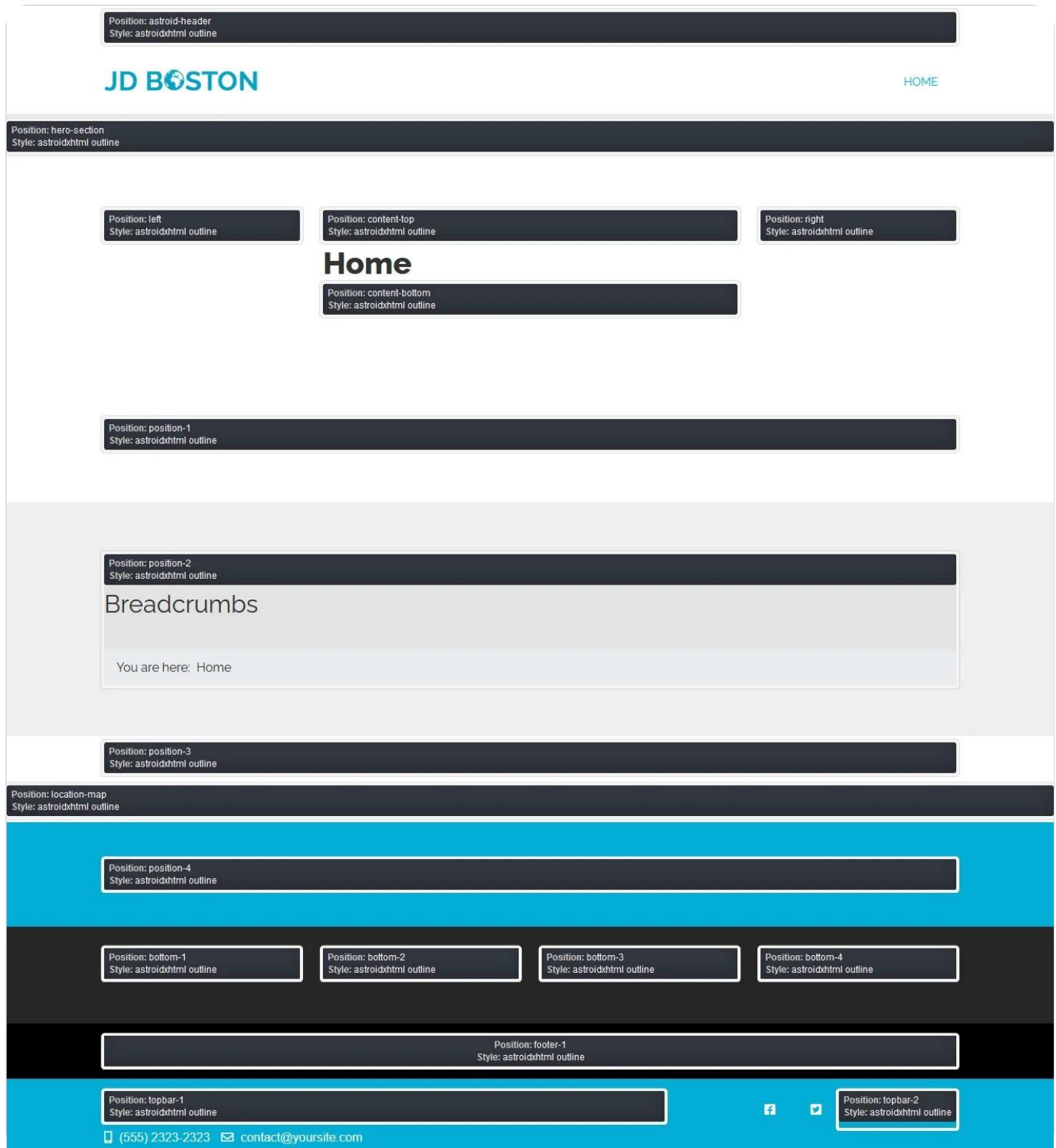
Unfortunately, we have to start with one of the more complicated topics, which is modules. These are little units of content that can appear in many places on a page like building blocks. Using them takes some getting used to, so let's try it out on the homepage.

To understand your options, it's best to start by enabling the preview mode for module positions. For that, go to System > Global Configuration > Templates. Here, set Preview Module Positions to Enabled, save, and close.



The screenshot shows the Joomla! administration interface for the 'Template: Options' configuration page. The top navigation bar includes 'System', 'Users', 'Menus', 'Content', 'Components', 'Extensions', and 'Help'. The left sidebar lists various system components like 'Global Configuration', 'Articles', 'Banners', etc. The main content area has two tabs: 'Templates' and 'Permissions'. Under the 'Templates' tab, there's a section for 'Global configuration for templates.' with a blue information icon. Below this, the 'Preview Module Positions' toggle is currently set to 'Disabled' (indicated by a red button), and a blue arrow points to the 'Enabled' button. Other settings include 'Upload Size (MB)' set to 10, and 'Supported File Formats' with input fields for 'Valid Image Formats' (gif, bmp, jpg, jpeg, png), 'Valid Source Formats' (txt, less, ini, xml, js, php, css, scss, sass), and 'Valid Font Formats' (woff, ttf, otf).

Then, go back to your list of templates and click the Preview button (the eye icon). This will then display all available positions on your page where you can add modules and the names of the positions.

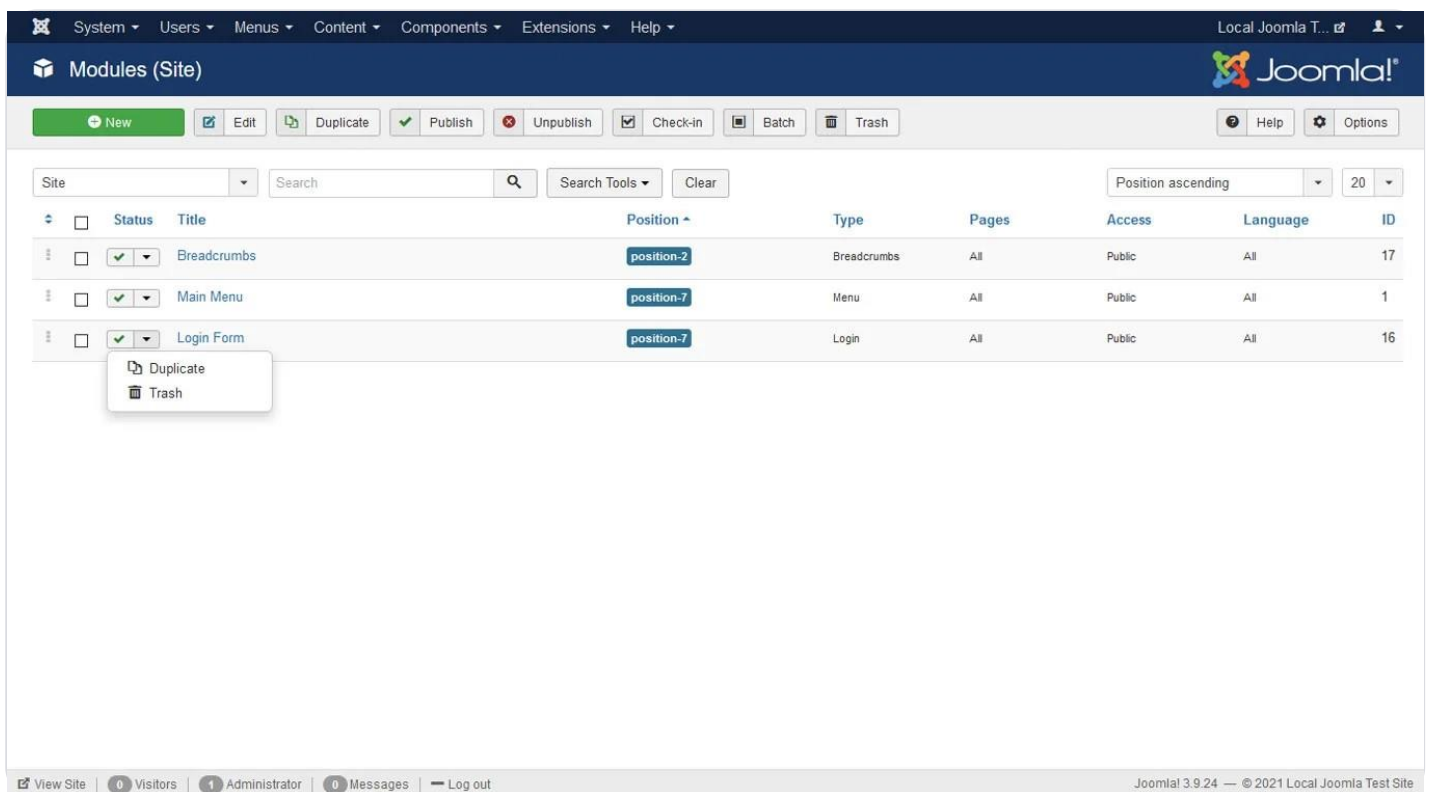


Quick note: Don't forget to switch the preview off when you are done assigning modules.

8. Assign Modules to Positions

Alright, now that you know where your modules can go, how do you assign them to those positions? All of that happens under Extensions > Modules.

Here, you can see all modules currently active on your site plus the positions, pages, users, and languages they are assigned to. To get rid of anything already on your site, such as the login form and breadcrumbs, simply click the downward arrow button under Status and select Trash.



The screenshot shows the Joomla! administrator interface for managing modules. The top navigation bar includes links for System, Users, Menus, Content, Components, Extensions, and Help. The main header is titled "Modules (Site)" and features the Joomla! logo. Below the header is a toolbar with buttons for New, Edit, Duplicate, Publish, Unpublish, Check-in, Batch, and Trash. A search bar and a "Search Tools" dropdown are also present. The main content area displays a table of modules with columns for Status, Title, Position, Type, Pages, Access, Language, and ID. Three modules are listed: Breadcrumbs (position-2), Main Menu (position-7), and Login Form (position-7). A dropdown menu is open under the Status column for the Login Form module, showing options for Duplicate and Trash. The footer of the interface shows the Joomla! version (3.9.24) and copyright information (© 2021 Local Joomla Test Site).

Status	Title	Position	Type	Pages	Access	Language	ID
☒	Breadcrumbs	position-2	Breadcrumbs	All	Public	All	17
☒	Main Menu	position-7	Menu	All	Public	All	1
☒	Login Form	position-7	Login	All	Public	All	16

If you want to add more modules to your site, under New in the upper left corner, you find a whole lot of options.

SystemUsersMenusContentComponentsExtensionsHelp

Local Joomla T...

Modules (Site)

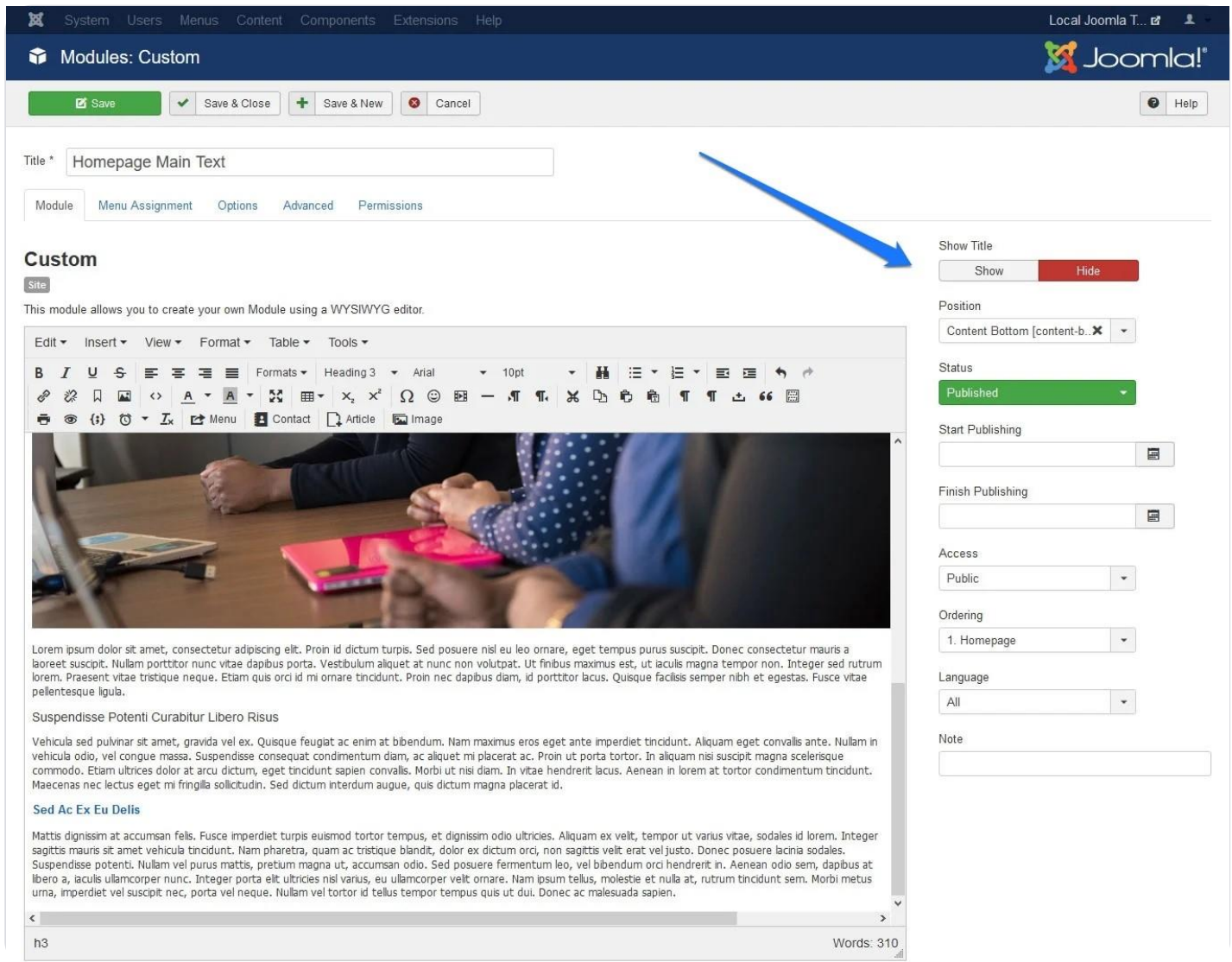
Select a Module Type:

Articles - Archived	This module shows a list of the calendar months with Archived Articles. After you have...
Articles - Categories	This module displays a list of categories from one parent category.
Articles - Category	This module displays a list of articles from one or more categories.
Articles - Latest	This module shows a list of the most recently published and current Articles.
Articles - Most Read	This module shows a list of the published Articles which have the highest number of page...
Articles - Newsflash	The Newsflash Module will display a fixed number of articles from a specific category.
Articles - Related	This module displays other Articles that are related to the one being viewed. These...
Banners	The Banner Module displays the active Banners from the Component.
Breadcrumbs	This module displays the Breadcrumbs.
Custom	This module allows you to create your own Module using a WYSIWYG editor.
Feed Display	This module allows the displaying of a syndicated feed.
Footer	This module shows the Joomla! copyright information.
Language Switcher	This module displays a list of available Content Languages (as defined and published in...
Latest Users	This module displays the latest registered users.
Login	This module displays a username and password login form. It also displays a link to...
Menu	This module displays a menu on the Frontend.
Random Image	This module displays a random image from your chosen folder.
Search	This module will display a search box.
Smart Search	This is a search module for the Smart Search system.
Statistics	The Statistics Module shows information about your server installation together with...
Syndication Feeds	Smart Syndication Module that creates a Syndicated Feed for the page where the Module is...
Tags - Popular	This module displays tags used on the site in a list or a cloud layout. Tags can be...
Tags - Similar	The Similar Tags Module displays links to other items with similar tags. The closeness...
Who's Online	The Who's Online Module displays the number of Anonymous Users (Guests) and Registered...
Wrapper	This module shows an iframe window to specified location.

Let's say you wanted to include some text about you and your site on the homepage. The first thing to check is where on the page it should go. In this case, this is content-bottom.

Then, go to the Modules menu, create a new module via the green button in the upper left corner, and choose Custom as the type. This allows you to create your own content block using a WYSIWYG (what you see is what you get) editor.

Published and that you pick the correct template location under Position (pay attention that you also select your active theme!). In this case, we also want to hide the module title.



The screenshot displays the Joomla! Modules: Custom configuration page. The title field is set to "Homepage Main Text". The "Module" tab is selected, showing a WYSIWYG editor with a placeholder image and dummy text. The right sidebar contains various settings: "Show Title" (with "Show" and "Hide" buttons, where a blue arrow points to the "Hide" button), "Position" (set to "Content Bottom [content-b.X]"), "Status" (set to "Published"), "Start Publishing" and "Finish Publishing" date pickers, "Access" (set to "Public"), "Ordering" (set to "1. Homepage"), "Language" (set to "All"), and a "Note" field. The bottom of the editor shows "h3" and "Words: 310".

Then, go to Menu Assignment (the tab below the title) and use the drop-down menu to choose the pages you want to show this module on. In this case, it's Only on the pages selected and then Home.

System Users Menus Content Components Extensions Help Local Joomla T... Joomla!

Modules: Custom

Title * Homepage Main Text

Module Menu Assignment Options Advanced Permissions

Module Assignment Only on the pages selected

Menu Selection: Select: All, None | Expand: All, None Search

MAIN MENU

☒ Home (Alias: home)

Save and you should see it on your homepage (and only there).



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Suspendisse Potenti Curabitur Libero Risus

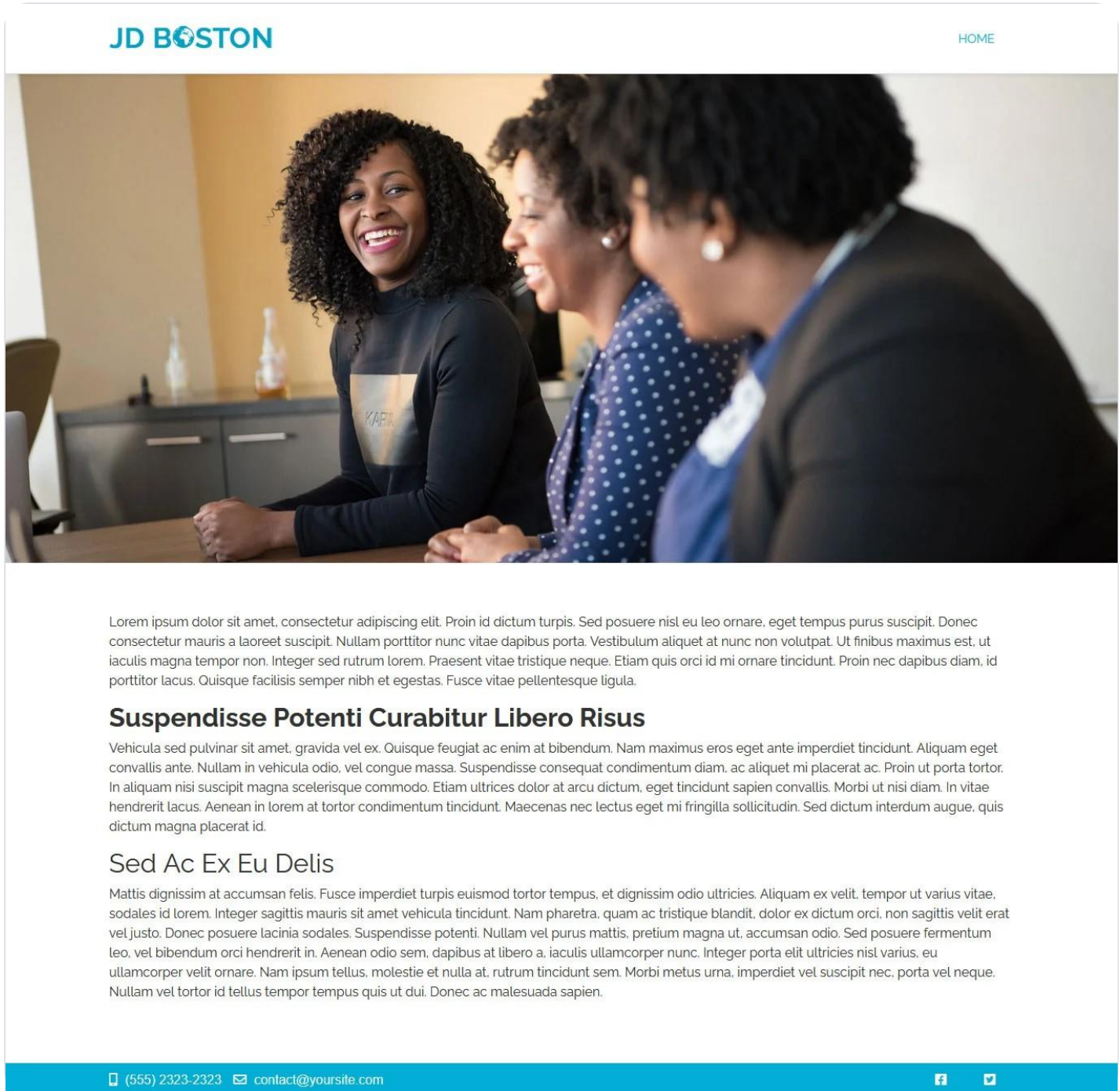
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You can use this same method to insert other things into Joomla pages like blog posts (we will talk about that later in the tutorial), banners, menus, images, and iframes. In addition, you can also add new modules via extensions (more on that below as well).

For example, this is what the homepage looks like when we add the main image in form of a slider at the hero-section position with the help of a [plugin](#) and move the text module to content-top:



Already better, isn't it?

9. Create New Pages

Now for something easier: pages. The first thing to learn here is that you create them in one place and make them appear in another. This is a general thing to keep in mind throughout the tutorial that anything you make in Joomla won't automatically show up on your site.

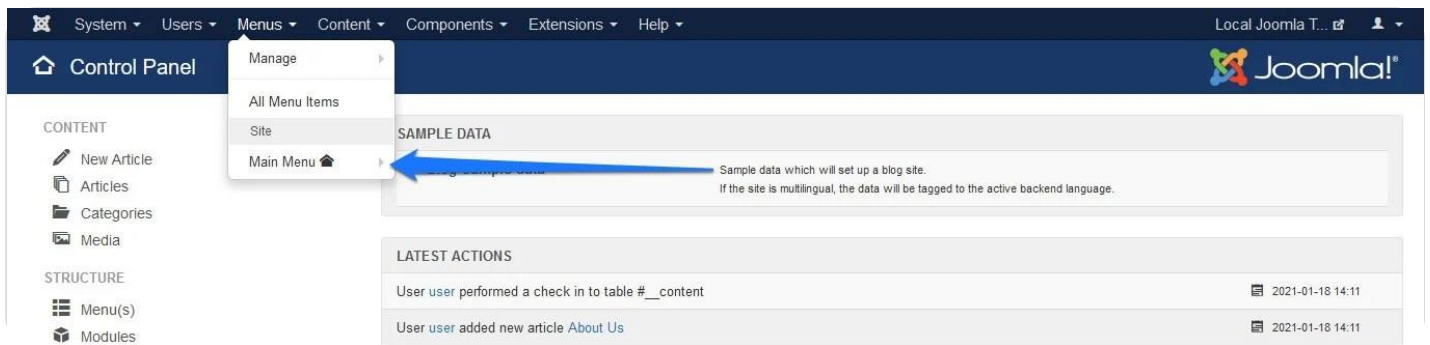
In this CMS, pages are simply called articles. This can be a little confusing you come from a blogging background but don't let that hold you up. You can create articles via Content > Articles > Add New Article. Alternatively, use the shortcut on the control panel. Both will get you to a very similar editing screen as you used before.

Create and format content the same way as you did earlier. When you are done, under Alias you are able to determine a permalink (meaning page URL). It often makes sense to put a

keyword here instead of using the article title. Under Status make sure that it is set to Publish before saving.

10. Assign Pages to the Joomla NavigationMenu

To allow visitors to access your new page, it's time to assign it to a menu. For that, under Menus, nd the one with the house icon assigned to it. That is your currently active one.



To assign a new link to it, hover over it and pick Add New Menu Item. Doing so will take you to the screen below.

The screenshot shows the Joomla! administration interface for creating a new menu item. The top navigation bar includes links for System, Users, Menus, Content, Components, Extensions, and Help. The main header displays the Joomla! logo and the title 'Menus: New Item'. Below the header, there are buttons for 'Save', 'Save & Close', 'Save & New', and 'Cancel'. The form is divided into several sections:

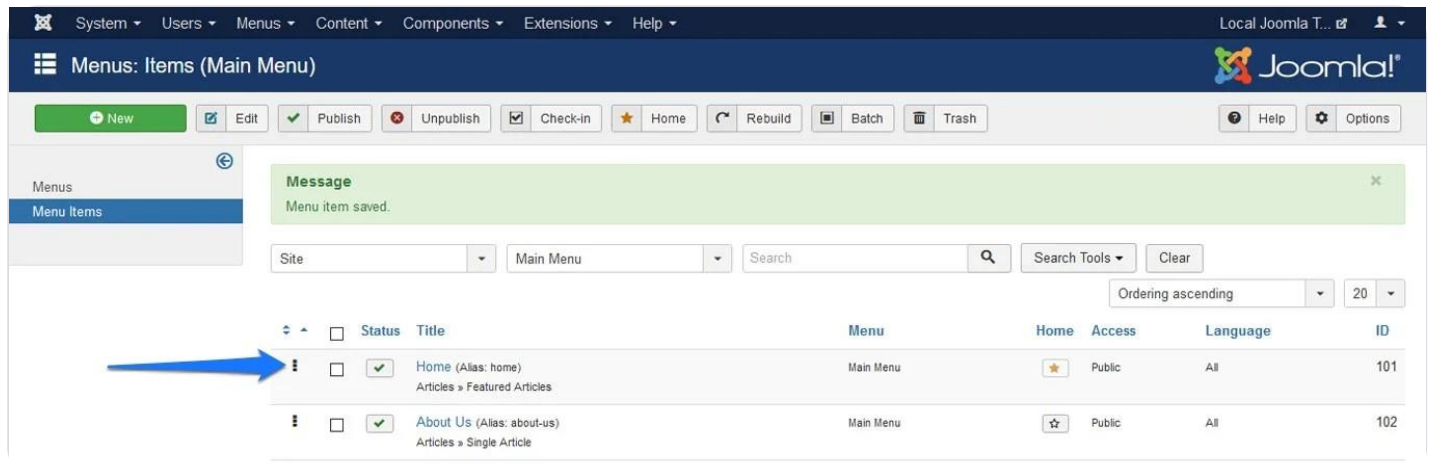
- Menu Title ***: A text input field.
- Alias**: A text input field with the value 'Auto-generate from title'.
- Tabs**: A row of tabs including 'Details', 'Link Type', 'Page Display', 'Metadata', 'Astroid Menu Options', 'Banner Options', 'Open Graph', and 'Module Assignment'. The 'Details' tab is currently selected.
- Menu Item Type ***: A dropdown menu with a 'Select' button next to it.
- Link**: A text input field.
- Target Window**: A dropdown menu with the value 'Parent'.
- Template Style**: A dropdown menu with the value '- Use Default -'.
- Menu ***: A dropdown menu with the value 'Main Menu'.
- Parent Item**: A dropdown menu with the value 'Menu Item Root'.
- Ordering**: A text input field with the value 'Ordering will be available after saving'.
- Status**: A dropdown menu with the value 'Published'.
- Default Page**: A dropdown menu with the value 'Yes'.
- Access**: A dropdown menu with the value 'Public'.
- Language**: A dropdown menu with the value 'All'.
- Note**: A text input field.

Under Menu Item Type, select Article >Single Article. Then, under Select Article, you can choose existing content on your site via Select and then clicking on the title of the one you want to assign.

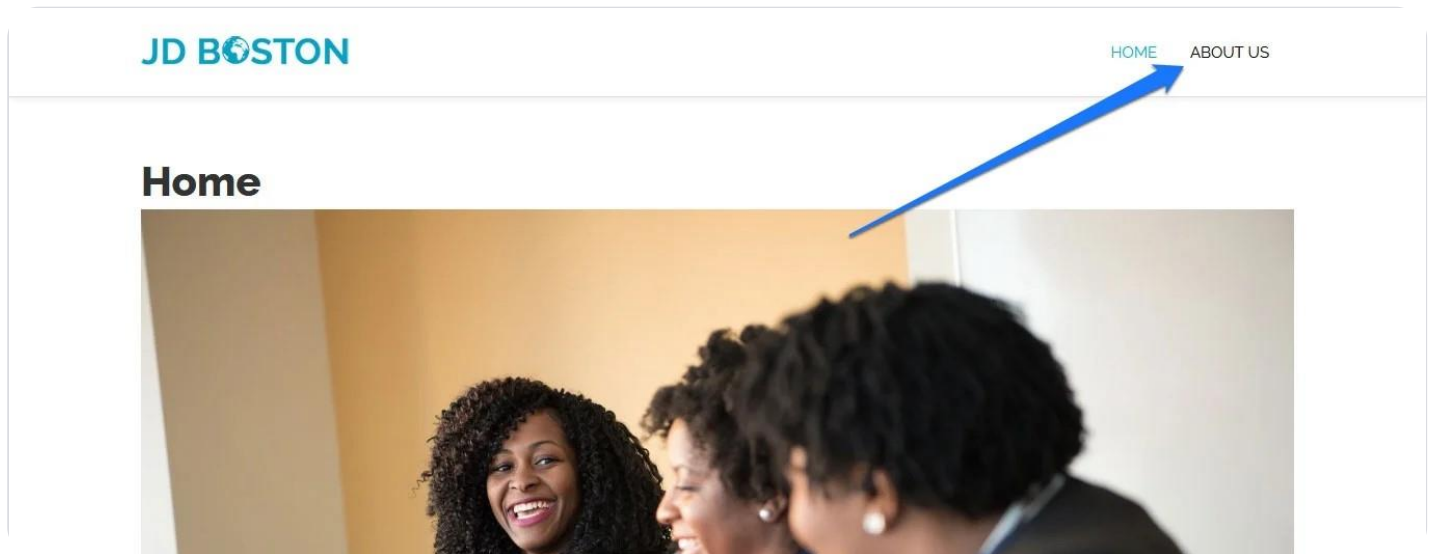
This screenshot shows the same Joomla! 'Menus: New Item' form, but with the 'Options' tab selected. The 'Menu Item Type' dropdown is now set to 'Single Article'. A blue box highlights the 'Select Article' section, which includes a dropdown menu with the value 'About Us' and buttons for 'Edit' and 'Clear'. A blue arrow points from the 'Select Article' section to the 'Menu Item Type' dropdown. The 'Link' field now contains the URL 'index.php?option=com_content&view=article'. The 'Status' dropdown is still set to 'Published'.

Now you only need to input a Menu Title at the top (which is the text that will appear in the menu) and make sure the menu to assign it to is selected on the right.

When you now save and close, you can use the three-dot icon on the left to drag menu items around and change their order.



When you are satisfied and go back to your site, the new item should now appear.



11. Add a Blog Section

Publishing blog posts in Joomla basically works the same way as creating pages. The only difference: you assign your blog posts to a category. For that, we first need one.

Go to Content > Categories > Add New Category. It takes you to the same editor as before.

In this case, you only have to input a name at the top (e.g. ↑ Blog) then save and close.

System Users Menus Content Components Extensions Help Local Joomla! T...

Articles: New Category

Save Save & Close Save & New Cancel Help

Title * Alias

Category Options **Single Blog Options** Publishing Permissions

Description

Edit Insert View Format Table Tools

Formats Paragraph Tahoma 9pt

Parent - No parent -

Status Published

Access Public

Language All

Tags

Note

Version Note

View Site 0 Visitors 1 Administrator 0 Messages Log out Joomla! 3.9.24 — © 2021 Local Joomla Test Site

After that, you can assign the category to your menu the same way you did with the page before. Only this time, under Menu Item Type, choose Articles > Category Blog.

System Users Menus Content Components Extensions Help Local Joomla! T...

Menus: New Item

Save Save & Close Save & New Cancel Help

Menu Title * Alias

Details Category Blog Layout Options Integration Link Type Page Display Metadata **Astroid Menu Options** Banner Options Open Graph Blog Options

Module Assignment

Menu Item Type *

Choose a Category *

Tags

Link

Target Window

Template Style

Menu *

Parent Item

Ordering Ordering will be available after saving.

Status Published

Default Page ☒ Yes ☐ No



Make sure to select your Blog category under Choose a Category. Then, check that it's assigned to the right menu and give it a menu title that makes sense. Save and close to get it

on your site. From now on, any article that you assign to your Blog category will show up in the form of a blog post under that menu item.



My First Blog Post

Super User | Blog | Published: 18 January 2021 | Hits: 0

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[Read more: My First Blog Post](#)

12[↑]. Install Extensions

The next thing we want to talk about in this Joomla beginner tutorial is extensions. With their help, you can bring new features and functionality to your site. You find them in the [official Joomla extension directory](#).

Joomla! Extensions Directory™

Download Launch

Home Browse Extensions Search Community Support Vulnerable Extensions Log in Register

Find the extension you're looking for GO

Category	Count
Photos & Images	650
Slideshow	279
Galleries	143
Images	90
Rotators	55
Panorama	4
eCards	3
Social Web	489
Social Display	211
Social Share	101
Social Media	87
Social Presence	32
Social Comments	29
Social Content Locks	9
Social Buying	2
Social Edition	1
Social Gamification	1
News Display	468
Articles Display	294
Article Elements	47
Tables & Lists	37
Content infos	23
Quotes	13
Notes	12
Popular Content	8
Reading lists	2
Quotes - Cloud based	1
Style & Design	307
Popups & iFrames	78
Modules Panel	53
Design	46
Templating	20
Articles styling	17
Modules Management	16
Page Background	15
Typography	15
Print & PDF	12
Site Management	276
Analytics	89
SEO & Metadata	85
Cookie Control	45
URL Redirection	15
SEF	11
Site Links	10
Browsers & Web Standards	8
Short URL	4
Error pages	3

[View All](#)

Just input a search term, use the categories or the advanced search to find what you are looking for. With more than 6,000 available extensions, it can be difficult to make a choice, so you can start with collections like this:

- [Joomla Extensions: 101 Essential Extensions You Need In Your Life Now](#)
- [Top Rated Joomla Extensions](#)

Once you know what to install on your site, you have several ways of doing so. You can find all extensions under Extensions > Manage > Install. When you are there for the first time, at the top, use the option to set up ↑ Install from web. When you do, it gives you access to everything in the Joomla extension directory right from your back end. Click on any extension and then hit the Install button (twice) to automatically load it onto your site. Should this not work for you for some reason, you can simply download the extension or copy the URL where it is located. After that, you are able to use the Upload Package File and Install from URL tabs to get it on your site. Note, that you might still have to activate parts of the extension under Extensions > Manage ↑. From here, you are also able to deactivate and uninstall extensions you no longer need. Unfortunately, it's a bit confusing and crowded, so you might have to search for your extension by name.

For this example, we have installed the popular [JCE content editor](#). With it present and active and after setting it as the default editor under System > Global Configuration, the content creation experience changes notably.

Joomla Tutorial: Final Thoughts

Joomla is an excellent tool to build a website with. The CMS is powerful, flexible, widely extendable, and also free of charge.

In this Joomla tutorial, you have learned how to install the platform, find your way around its back end, change your site design, add content, and install extensions.

Of course, there is a lot more to learn. However, you now know enough about how to use Joomla to start exploring on your own. If you want to dive deeper into the platform, here are some recommended resources:

- [Joomla documentation](#)
- [Joomla forums](#)